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UAE pushes remote work to boost efficiency

STUDY SAYS HYBRID MODEL INCREASES PRODUCTIVITY AND CAN EASE TRAFFIC

DUBAI
BY FAISAL MASUDI
Assistant Editor

A new report has highlighted UAE's success in adopting remote work, with studies under way to make the model more commonplace. The white paper said remote work increased overall productivity by 4.6 per cent in the UAE after the pandemic. "Other benefits may include cutting traffic congestion during peak times, something the Dubai Roads and Transport Authority is currently studying," the report said. In November 2024, a study, shared by RTA, found flexible working hours can reduce morning peak travel time across Dubai by 30 per cent. The UAE's Artificial Intelligence, Digital Economy, and Remote Work Applications Office yesterday released the paper on the best practices and future policies that can be developed and implemented by the UAE government in activating the remote work system. The paper, titled 'Remote

Working in the UAE', was created in collaboration with PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC). It aims to enhance remote work systems by leveraging global trends and the expertise developed by the UAE government during the Covid-19 pandemic. The goal is to design a future of flexible and hybrid work that relies on emerging technologies to shape advanced remote work systems.

Research-based approach
Omar Sultan Al Olama, Minister of State for Artificial Intelligence, Digital Economy, and Remote Work Applications, in the foreword to the report, said: "This whitepaper serves as a roadmap for public and private sector on enabling remote work for their teams. Remote work is here to stay, let us embrace it together."

4.6%
increase in overall productivity in UAE due to remote work



WILDFIRE SPARKS EVACUATIONS IN LOS ANGELES

Firefighters battle flames that engulfed the upscale Pacific Palisades area in Los Angeles, California, yesterday. A fast-moving wildfire ripped through the neighbourhood, forcing thousands of people to evacuate as the region braced for a brutal wind storm that could last well into the weekend. **SEE ALSO P10**

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Star-rated rents benefit Dubai tenants

New system shifts bargaining power towards tenants

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

Dubai's tenants are now getting an upper hand when negotiating rents based on star ratings of buildings with the new digital Rental Index. Under this system, landlords must disclose their

building's star rating during lease agreements, which directly impacts the permissible rental increases. For example, a 4-star building may justify up to a 20 per cent rent hike, while older, poorly maintained properties with lower ratings face challenges in demanding higher rents.

The star-rating system has shifted bargaining power towards tenants, particularly in older buildings that lack regular upkeep. Meanwhile, new and higher-rated buildings benefit from premium pricing

due to superior facilities and amenities. Freehold apartment home-owner associations (OAs) are under pressure to improve building maintenance to meet higher tenant expectations. This could lead to increased service charges and stricter demands on property management companies for better upkeep. Industry experts predict that the star-rating system will moderate rental hikes and bring a qualitative assessment to Dubai's rental market. **SEE ALSO P5**

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